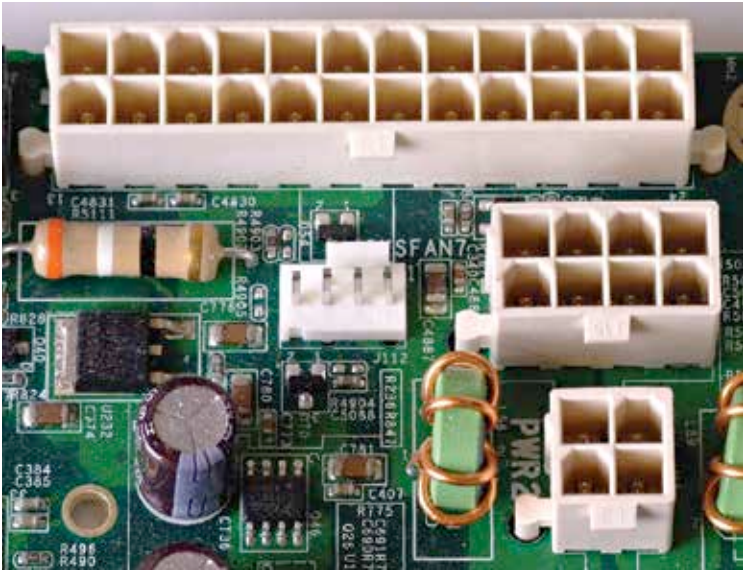


Key points of a motherboard

With the number of components they house, chances are, you will never find two motherboards identical to each other. Keeping that in mind, it is important to understand what all functions are carried out by the motherboard.

The power distribution: A motherboard is the primary source of power for all components attached to it. It receives the energy from the Power Supply Unit installed inside the casing using power input connectors, the most important of which is a (20+4)-pin connector. However, it may not be sufficient to power everything you connect to the board. For example, a powerful CPU demands more. For such cases, the board has extra power input points in the form of 8-pin or 4-pin connectors.



24-pin, 8-pin and 4-pin Power connectors on a motherboard

Data distribution and management: Apart from distributing power amongst the components, it also distributes and manages the data flow. This is the most crucial part of what a motherboard does. The physical data bus(es) are part of the motherboard. Their responsibilities of data flow management are normally carried out by the chipset installed on the motherboard. This used to include the Northbridge (Memory Controller